

Weekly Economic Commentary 20 April 2026

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 By [Westpac New Zealand Economics](#)

08:30 April 20 2026

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Analysis and forecasts of the economy and markets, along with previews of data for the week ahead.



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Oil shock begins to surface in data

The past week has delivered some further insight on the early impact of the Middle East conflict on the New Zealand economy. Unsurprisingly, that data points to some marked changes in spending patterns and clear upward pressure on prices for energy products. Even greater impacts are certain to be evident over coming months as the shock transmits through the economy.

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